



ACTAI • WEEK 02 • LECTURE 01

Creating with AI: Images

Turn a sentence into a picture — and learn to control exactly what you get.

Week 2 begins — the creation week

WHAT YOU'LL MAKE TODAY

From a sentence to a picture



“a cat astronaut floating in space, oil painting”



“minimalist mountain logo, flat vector style”

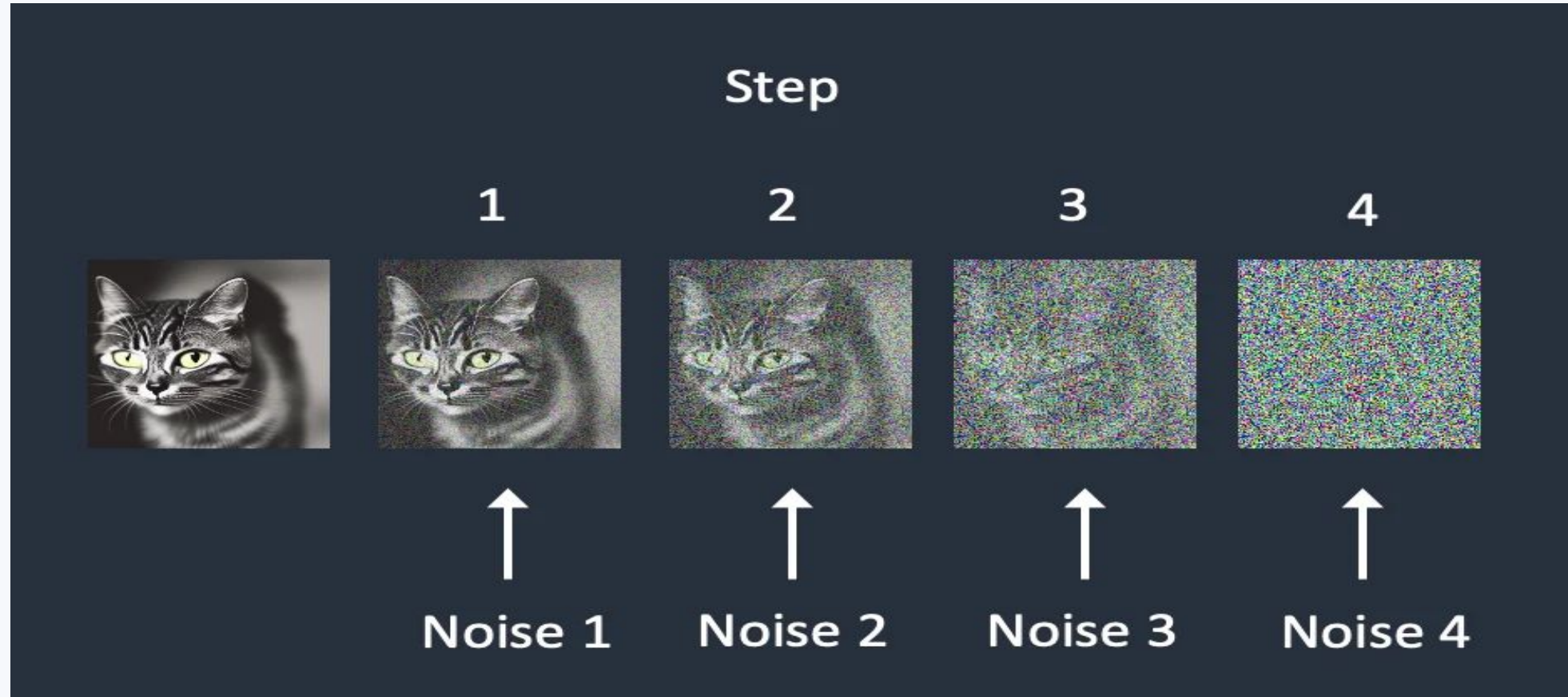


“cozy rainy cafe window at night, watercolour”

Every one of these started as a few words. By the end of class, you'll be writing those words well.

HOW IT WORKS, IN 60 SECONDS

It sculpts a picture out of noise



It starts from random static and removes it step by step until the picture matches your words. That process is called “diffusion” — you don't need the maths, just the picture.

YOUR FREE TOOLKIT

Pick a tool — most need no real sign-up

NO SIGN-UP · JUST OPEN & TYPE



Freegen.app freegen.app

Instant, unlimited, no account



Craiyon craiyon.com

Nine options at once, totally free; lower quality.

FREE · QUICK ACCOUNT YOU PROBABLY ALREADY HAVE



Google Gemini
gemini.google.com

Best photorealism & text. Google login.



Microsoft Copilot
copilot.microsoft.com

Free DALL·E 3, strong text. Microsoft login.



Ideogram
ideogram.ai

Best for words in images: posters, logos.

Need it copyright-safe? Adobe Firefly (firefly.adobe.com) is trained only on licensed images. · No account? Start with Perchance. Want top quality? Gemini.

Six ingredients of a great prompt

Subject — a red fox

Details — fluffy, curled up asleep

Style — watercolour painting

Composition — close-up, centered

Lighting / mood — soft morning light

Aspect ratio — 16:9 widescreen



PROMPT — copy & paste

A red fox, fluffy and curled up asleep, watercolour painting, close-up and centered, soft morning light, 16:9 widescreen.

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

Vague in, vague out



VAGUE PROMPT

PROMPT — copy & paste

a dog



DETAILED PROMPT

PROMPT — copy & paste

A golden retriever puppy running on a beach at sunset, splashing water, photo, shallow depth of field



Make your first image



Try it now

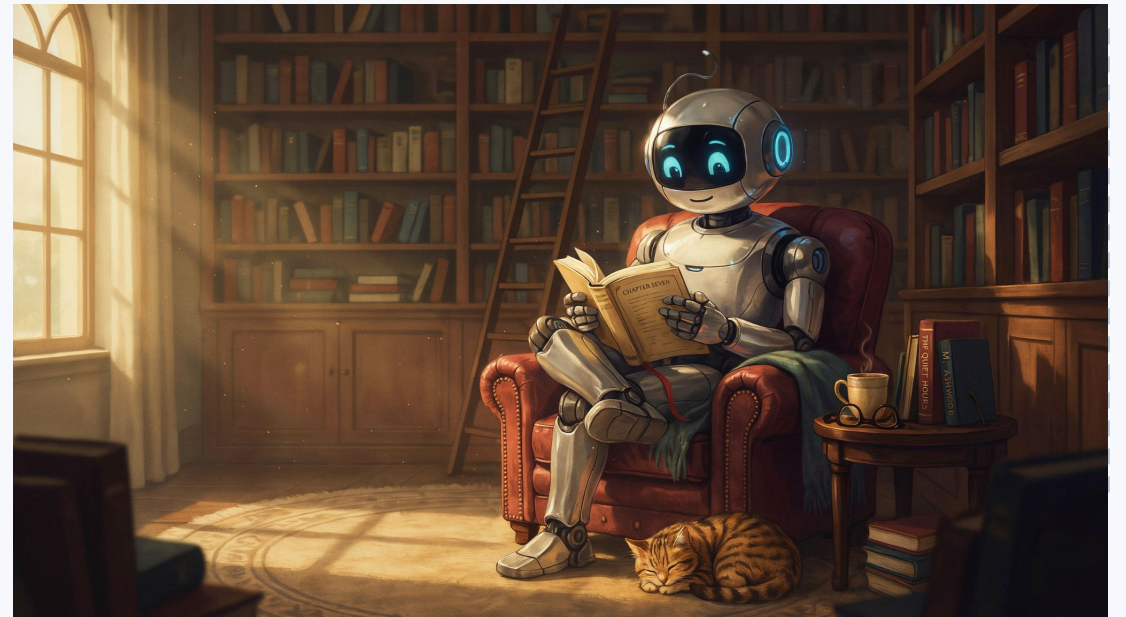


10 min

1. Open any tool from the toolkit.
2. Paste the starter prompt on the right.
3. Then change ONE thing (style, colour, subject).
4. Generate again and see what changed.

PROMPT – copy & paste

A friendly robot reading a book in a cozy library,
warm light, digital art, 16:9



STYLE & MEDIUM

Same subject, any look you want

BASE PROMPT

a red fox in a forest, ____ ← add one of the styles below



...as a photograph



...as a watercolour



...as a 3D render



...as a pencil sketch

One subject, four styles — just by swapping the last few words. Try realistic, cartoon, oil painting, pixel art, anime, blueprint...

Aspect ratio and composition

Aspect ratio — the shape

- 1:1 square — social posts, profile pics
- 16:9 wide — slides, video, banners
- 9:16 tall — phone wallpapers, stories
- 4:3 classic — prints, documents

Composition — the framing

- close-up / extreme close-up
- wide shot / establishing shot
- top-down / bird's-eye view
- portrait / centered / rule of thirds

Just add these words to your prompt — e.g. "...top-down, 1:1".

Remix your image



Try it now



10 min

1. Keep your subject from Activity 1.
2. Re-run it with each style on the right.
3. Add an aspect ratio too (e.g. 1:1).
4. Pick your favourite of the set.

ADD ONE OF THESE TO YOUR PROMPT

- ...as a watercolour painting
- ...as a 3D render
- ...as a vintage poster
- ...as a pencil sketch
- ...as a neon cyberpunk scene

EDITING & ITERATING

You don't restart — you refine

Got something close? Describe the change in plain words instead of starting over.



BEFORE



AFTER

EDIT INSTRUCTIONS — just ask

make the background a sunset · remove the hat · add sunglasses · make it brighter

PLAYGROUND · ACTIVITY

Product Photography



Try it now



10 min

1. Select any product and create a product photo
2. Re-run it with each style on the right.
3. Add an aspect ratio too (e.g. 1:1).
4. Pick your favourite of the set.



FOR EVERY FIELD

Where you'll actually use this



Business

posters, ads, product mockups,
pitch visuals



Study & teaching

diagrams, flashcards, concept
illustrations



Design & arts

mood boards, concept art, style
exploration



Social & content

thumbnails, post graphics,
banners



Presentations

custom slide art instead of
stock photos



Personal

invitations, gifts, wallpapers,
avatars

KNOW THE QUIRKS

Where AI images still slip up



Hands & fingers — often wrong; count them.

Text — can come out garbled (Gemini/Ideogram are best).

Counting — 'exactly 3' is hard for it.

Consistency — the same character looks different each time.

Bias — it leans on stereotypes unless you specify.

The fix is usually: regenerate, add detail, or pick a tool that's better at that thing.

USE IT RESPONSIBLY

Four rules to keep in mind



No real people in harmful or fake situations

Don't make deepfakes or put real individuals in things they didn't do.



Copyright & ownership are murky

Rules differ by tool and country. For commercial use, prefer Firefly and check the licence.



Disclose AI-generated images

Especially in news, academic work, or anything that could mislead.



Mind bias & stereotypes

Be specific and inclusive in prompts; review what comes out.

YOUR TASK

Create one image for your own field



Fill in the blanks and generate

Use the six ingredients: **subject + details + style + composition + lighting + aspect ratio**. Make something you could actually use in your studies or work.

TEMPLATE — copy & fill in

a [subject], [details], [style], [composition], [lighting], [aspect ratio]

Keep your best result — we'll build on these creative skills all week.



LECTURE RECAP

You're an image-maker now.

Free tools, the six-ingredient prompt, style and framing control, editing by conversation, and the limits and ethics to respect.

Next — Audio: AI voices and music. We give your creations a sound.